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"U.S. AI Leadership and Global Governance: Balancing Innovation and Strict Oversight"

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Attachments

White paper AI Action plan

U.S. AI Leadership and Global Governance:

**Balancing
Innovation
And
Strict Oversight**



Moss M.Jacques

“AI is likely to be either the best or worst thing to happen to humanity.”

Hawking

Stephen

U.S. AI Leadership and Global Governance: Balancing Innovation and Strict Oversight

Strategic Investments in AI Research and Development

On his second day in office, President Trump announced the Stargate Project, marking the beginning of a renewed global race for AI dominance. To maintain leadership in this rapidly evolving field, the U.S. must prioritize substantial investments in AI research, infrastructure, and talent. A strong commitment from both the government and private sector is essential to driving innovation while ensuring responsible governance. There's no doubt that robust investment is the foundation of AI leadership. The U.S. government and private sector must significantly fund AI research, infrastructure, and talent to stay ahead.

Public funding for AI R&D has grown in recent years – for example, the National Science Foundation launched seven new AI Research Institutes with a \$140 million investment focused on trustworthy AI, climate, cybersecurity, and health applications (1). Overall federal AI R&D spending more than doubled from about \$1.3 billion in 2017 to \$3.2 billion in 2022 (2), reflecting a recognition of AI's strategic importance. Private-sector investment dwarfs public funding and is a key U.S. strength. American tech companies and startups are pouring capital into AI at unprecedented levels. In FY2025, Microsoft alone plans to invest roughly \$80 billion in AI-enabled data centers (over half of it in the U.S.) to power advanced AI models and applications (3). Other industry leaders like Google and Amazon are also “investing heavily” in AI, alongside a wave of new startups, and more private capital is flowing into the AI sector (4). Thanks to this combination of venture capital, corporate R&D, and government support, the United States currently “leads the global AI race” driven by innovations from companies of all sizes (5). To maintain this edge, experts recommend increasing federal support for fundamental AI research (e.g. through NSF, DARPA, and DOE programs) and expanding public-private partnerships. Strategic initiatives like the CHIPS and Science Act authorize tens of billions for science (including AI), and a proposed AI R&D roadmap in the Senate calls for \$32 billion of federal investment (6). Sustained funding growth, matched with incentives for commercialization, will drive the next wave of AI breakthroughs. The U.S. should also support critical AI infrastructure (such as a National AI Research Resource for computing power) and continue to “double down

on its strengths” – world-class universities, vibrant startups, and leading tech firms – to cement its leadership(7). By jointly investing in innovation, government and industry can ensure America stays at the cutting edge of AI advancement while others race to catch up.

Smart and Adaptive Regulatory Frameworks

Shaping AI with thoughtful regulation is essential to ensure ethical use and public trust, but it must be done without smothering innovation. U.S. policymakers are grappling with how to oversee AI in a balanced way. A Senate hearing in May 2023 emphasized that *how* the U.S. sets AI rules will “help set the tone globally for AI regulation and how to address AI risks without stifling innovation”(8). There is broad agreement that certain AI applications need guardrails – all witnesses at the hearing (including OpenAI’s CEO and IBM’s AI ethics lead) agreed on the need for some form of AI regulation (9). For instance, AI leaders have proposed safety requirements and even licensing highly advanced AI models, along with rigorous testing/auditing before and after deployment (10). IBM’s representative argued for a risk-based, use-specific approach: rather than regulating AI technology itself, focus regulations on high-risk use cases (much like the EU’s draft AI Act, which imposes stricter rules on sensitive uses such as AI in hiring or loan decisions) (11). Lower-risk applications would face lighter touch oversight, preserving space for experimentation. This kind of tiered framework can protect the public from harmful AI outcomes (bias, unsafe systems, etc.) while avoiding one-size-fits-all rules that could impede benign innovations.

The U.S. has begun developing guidance and standards instead of broad AI laws. Agencies are applying existing laws (e.g. the FTC policing deceptive AI practices, EEOC addressing biased hiring algorithms) (12). The National Institute of Standards and Technology released an AI Risk Management Framework to guide organizations in designing trustworthy AI, and the White House published a *Blueprint for an AI Bill of Rights* outlining principles like data privacy, algorithmic discrimination protections, and human oversight(13). However, experts note that more is needed – the lack of a comprehensive national AI law means the U.S. is often *reacting* to other countries’ approaches (like Europe’s AI Act) rather than setting the agenda (14). To lead, the U.S. may need to craft its own flexible but enforceable AI rules – for example, requiring transparency for AI systems that affect consumers, mandating bias audits for high-impact algorithms, and ensuring accountability when AI causes harm. Narrowly targeted legislation can address urgent risks (for example, a proposed bill to ban malicious deepfakes used in non-consensual pornography) without overburdening the broader AI ecosystem (15).Crucially, any regulatory framework should be updated continuously in step with AI’s rapid evolution and involve industry input. A heavy-handed approach could “discourage investment, deter start-ups, and compromise American leadership” Industry voices caution that the U.S. “cannot afford to slow its own private sector with heavy-handed regulations” and should instead adopt a common-sense approach that keeps the “wind at its back” Industry voices caution that the U.S. “cannot afford to slow its own private sector with heavy-handed regulations”

and should instead adopt a common-sense approach that keeps the “wind at its back”. (16). Sandboxing and pilot programs can help test AI oversight mechanisms in a controlled way. In sum, the U.S. should pursue agile, risk-proportionate regulations that ensure AI systems are safe, fair, and transparent, while still enabling innovators to thrive. By getting this balance right, America can both protect its values and foster an environment where responsible AI innovation flourishes – setting an example for other nations.

International Collaborations for Global AI Governance

No country can shape global AI norms alone – the U.S. must work closely with allies and multilateral organizations to develop consistent international AI governance. This collaboration is both strategic and value-driven: democracies want to promote AI that respects human rights and security worldwide, especially as authoritarian models of AI deployment gain ground. There are already several forums where the U.S. engages partners on AI policy. For example, the U.S.–EU Trade and Technology Council has a working group devoted to AI, aiming to align standards and develop a joint code of conduct for AI. The *Global Partnership on AI (GPAI)* – a multi-stakeholder initiative launched by U.S. allies like France and Canada – is another venue for sharing research and best practices on responsible AI. (Notably, the U.S. joined GPAI and recently supported integrating it into the OECD to give it a more stable structure (17). The Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development itself has been instrumental in convening like-minded nations – the OECD’s AI Principles (endorsed by 40+ countries including the U.S.) outline common commitments to safety, fairness, and accountability in AI. Building on that, the OECD’s AI Policy Observatory helps coordinate policy approaches.

High-level diplomatic coordination is also picking up. G7 leaders, in their 2023 Hiroshima summit communiqué, underscored the need for cooperation on AI, specifically calling for joint efforts to address the impacts of advanced AI models like ChatGPT (18). They launched the “Hiroshima AI Process” to have inclusive discussions (with the OECD and GPAI) on topics such as generative AI governance (19). Likewise, the United States participated in the UK’s Global AI Safety Summit (November 2023 at Bletchley Park) which brought together dozens of countries to begin coordinating on AI safety research and international monitoring of frontier AI systems. Moving forward, the U.S. can lead by advocating for interoperability between different nations’ AI regulations – essentially a common baseline of standards. The G7 has highlighted the “necessity of interoperability” among AI governance frameworks so that trustworthy AI can be fostered across borders (20). Concretely, this could mean aligning on definitions of high-risk AI, sharing assessment tools and best practices, and avoiding conflicting requirements on companies.

Working with allies also extends to joint R&D and talent development. The U.S. can expand scientific cooperation with partner nations (e.g. joint AI research centers or scholarship programs) to pool expertise. Furthermore, it should coordinate export controls and security

measures with allies to prevent dangerous AI tech from proliferating to hostile actors, while ensuring democracies maintain access to the best AI innovations. The U.S. State Department has even launched the *Partnership for Global Inclusivity on AI*, bringing together government and industry to ensure AI benefits are shared globally and aligned with democratic values (20) (21) . Through such initiatives, the U.S. and like-minded nations can present a united front in establishing AI norms – from banning AI-enabled human rights abuses (like mass surveillance and social credit scoring) to setting guidelines for military AI use. International standards bodies and treaties will likely play a role; the U.S. should actively participate in drafting any global AI accord to ensure it reflects openness, human rights, and innovation. In summary, by deepening alliances – with Europe, G7 partners, and emerging AI hubs – and by strengthening multilateral efforts (OECD, United Nations, GPAI), the U.S. can shape a global governance model where AI is developed and used responsibly. This collaborative leadership not only addresses transnational challenges (like AI-driven cyber threats or autonomous weapons) but also reinforces U.S. credibility as the world’s AI leader committed to the common good.

Ethical and Security Considerations in AI Development

Advancing AI technology comes with serious ethical responsibilities and security risks that must be proactively managed. On the ethical front, AI systems can profoundly impact people’s lives, so issues of bias, fairness, transparency, and privacy are paramount. Scholars note that AI presents three major areas of ethical concern for society: (1) privacy and surveillance, (2) bias and discrimination, and (3) the role of human judgment in decisions made by algorithms (22). In practice, AI algorithms have sometimes replicated or even amplified societal biases – for example, machine-learning models used in criminal sentencing or hiring have been found to reflect racial and gender biases present in their training data (23). Without careful oversight, AI could unintentionally entrench inequality (e.g. “redlining” in lending might re-emerge if credit AI models learn from historical discriminatory data (24). Ensuring algorithmic fairness is thus a key governance challenge. The U.S. can lead by establishing standards for testing AI systems for bias before deployment, mandating diverse and representative training data where possible, and requiring explanations for important automated decisions. Efforts like the White House’s AI Bill of Rights blueprint and NIST’s guidance encourage practices to mitigate bias and protect civil rights in AI (25) . Some cities and states have begun to require algorithmic audits (New York City now mandates bias audits for AI hiring tools, for instance). Federally, strengthening anti-discrimination enforcement to cover AI-driven decisions is an important step to ensure ethics are not sacrificed for expedience.

Another ethical imperative is transparency and human oversight. Critical decisions – such as medical diagnoses or loan approvals – should not be left to “black box” algorithms without recourse. Policies can require that AI is used to assist, not replace, human decision-makers in high-stakes domains, preserving a “human-in-the-loop” for judgment(26). Additionally, people

should be informed when AI is impacting them (for example, chatbots or deepfakes should be clearly labeled to distinguish them from human content⁽²⁷⁾). The U.S. should encourage development of *explainable AI* and set guidelines for transparency so that AI-driven processes can be inspected for errors or biases. This will build public trust in AI systems as they become more prevalent.

On the security side, AI's dual-use nature raises concerns for both national security and public safety. Malicious actors – from cybercriminals to foreign adversaries – can misuse AI tools in novel ways. Indeed, officials warn that “malicious actors may use AI tools to defraud the public” and conduct sophisticated scams or disinformation campaigns ⁽²⁷⁾,

One emerging threat is AI-generated content (deepfakes and AI voice clones) being used to spread misinformation or impersonate people for fraud. Such exploits can undermine democratic processes (e.g. fake videos of candidates) and erode trust in information. The U.S. needs to harden its defenses against AI-enabled threats by investing in detection of deepfakes, imposing penalties on AI-assisted fraud, and educating the public about verifying content. In 2023, the Biden administration required major AI firms to red-team their models for security flaws and share the results with the government ⁽²⁸⁾, an approach that should continue to ensure AI models don't have hidden dangerous capabilities or vulnerabilities.

AI is also becoming a battlefield technology, which introduces security and ethical challenges in warfare. The Department of Defense has recognized this by adopting ethical principles for AI in defense, pledging that even as it accelerates AI adoption for national security, it will maintain America's “steadfast commitment to responsible and lawful behavior” in the use of AI ⁽²⁹⁾. This means U.S. military AI (e.g. autonomous systems or decision aids) should be governed by rules of engagement and human control to prevent unintended escalation or violations of international law. The U.S. can lead global discussions on norms for military AI (such as banning fully autonomous weapons that operate without meaningful human oversight). More broadly, safeguarding AI safety is vital – advanced AI systems should be designed with fail-safes and tested for reliability, so they do not behave unpredictably in critical applications (whether in power grids, healthcare, or defense systems).

In summary, the U.S. must embed ethics and security into the AI lifecycle. This involves rigorous testing and validation of AI for biases and flaws, continuous monitoring of AI outcomes, and the ability to hold systems and developers accountable for harm. By developing strong ethical guidelines (for industry and government use alike) and investing in AI safety research, the U.S. can ensure that technological progress does not come at the expense of fundamental rights or security. Maintaining this balance is not only a moral responsibility but also key to sustaining public support for AI innovations.

Preparing the Economy and Workforce for the AI Era

AI has the potential to boost productivity and create new industries, but it will undoubtedly disrupt labor markets. To harness AI's benefits while minimizing job displacement, the U.S. needs a comprehensive economic and workforce development strategy. This starts with education and training: workers at all levels must be equipped with the skills to work alongside AI. The private sector and government can collaborate on large-scale upskilling and reskilling programs to help current workers adapt. As Microsoft's leadership has noted, America should "champion skilling programs that will enable widespread AI adoption and enhanced career opportunities across the economy" (30). Concretely, this could mean tech companies partnering with community colleges to teach AI-related skills, federal incentives for apprenticeship programs in tech, and online training initiatives to reach workers in industries from manufacturing to healthcare. Investing in human capital is as important as investing in R&D – a workforce fluent in using AI tools will amplify productivity rather than be replaced.

At the same time, we must acknowledge that AI will change the nature of many jobs. Recent analyses suggest that over 30% of U.S. workers could see at least half of their typical tasks impacted or automated by generative AI in the coming years (31). Unlike past automation which mainly affected routine factory jobs, this AI wave could disrupt white-collar and "nonroutine" roles – from office administration to legal drafting (32). This doesn't automatically imply mass unemployment; rather, many jobs will evolve, with AI handling certain tasks and employees focusing on those requiring human judgment, creativity, or interpersonal skills. Still, there will be displacement in some areas, and new job roles will emerge in others (such as AI model trainers, explainability experts, or maintenance of AI systems). To manage this transition, proactive policies are needed. The government can strengthen safety nets and adjustment assistance for workers who do lose jobs to AI – for example, extending unemployment benefits tied to retraining programs, or providing wage insurance that cushions income loss during a career shift. Mobility and lifelong learning should be encouraged so that workers can continuously update their skills as job requirements change.

Moreover, preparing the economy means supporting sectors and communities to benefit from AI. Small businesses, for instance, could increase their competitiveness by adopting AI tools – but they need access to affordable AI solutions and training on how to use them. Public programs that provide grants or technical assistance for AI adoption in smaller firms (say, an AI extension service akin to agricultural extensions) could spread productivity gains more evenly. STEM education at the K-12 and college levels also requires an upgrade: integrating AI literacy, data science, and critical thinking about technology into curricula will ensure the next generation is ready for AI-driven workplaces. Universities and vocational schools should expand programs in AI, machine learning, and related fields, not just for developers but for domain experts who can apply AI in areas like medicine, law, or finance.

Finally, fostering new industries and entrepreneurship in AI will create jobs to offset those lost. The U.S. can provide innovation-friendly environments through startup incubators, R&D tax credits, and regional tech hubs (some of which are funded by recent legislation). By driving AI

innovation across sectors – including entirely new fields we can’t yet imagine – the economy can generate roles that leverage uniquely human skills. Historically, technological revolutions (from the industrial age to the computer era) ultimately created more jobs than they destroyed, though not without painful adjustments. With smart planning, the U.S. can maximize AI’s upside for economic growth while easing the workforce through the transition. In short, human capital investment, education reform, and supportive labor policies are critical to ensure American workers thrive in the AI era rather than being left behind (33). This will also help maintain public support for the advancement of AI, as people see tangible benefits in their work and daily lives.

AI and The Preservation of Human Rights

While AI has the potential to drive progress and innovation, its development and deployment also pose serious risks to fundamental human rights, particularly freedom of expression, freedom of movement, and freedom of assembly. The increasing use of AI in surveillance, content moderation, predictive policing, and social control has sparked debates on its potential to stifle democracy, suppress dissent, and infringe on personal liberties. To ensure AI serves humanity rather than oppresses it, a comprehensive AI action plan must be developed, one that safeguards these fundamental freedoms while maintaining technological progress (34).

Freedom of Expression and AI: Protecting the Right to Speak and Be Heard

Freedom of expression is a cornerstone of democratic societies, enabling individuals to voice opinions, exchange ideas, and hold those in power accountable. However, AI-powered technologies such as automated content moderation, misinformation detection, and algorithm-driven censorship have raised concerns about the potential suppression of free speech.

Social media platforms, news aggregators, and online forums increasingly rely on AI algorithms to filter, rank, and remove content. While these systems are designed to combat hate speech, misinformation, and illegal content, they often lack the nuance to distinguish between harmful speech and legitimate expression. Automated moderation tools can disproportionately silence marginalized voices, misinterpret satire, and remove politically sensitive content under vague or biased policies. In authoritarian regimes, AI-driven censorship has been weaponized to suppress dissent, limit press freedom, and manipulate public discourse.(35)

To protect freedom of expression, an AI action plan must include:

- 1) Transparent content moderation policies that are clearly communicated to users and subject to public scrutiny.
- 2) Human oversight in AI-driven censorship to prevent wrongful suppression of speech.
- 3) Appeal mechanisms for content removal that allow users to challenge AI decisions.
- 4) Protection of whistleblowers and independent journalists from AI-enabled surveillance and retaliation.

By ensuring that AI respects the right to express opinions freely, societies can maintain open and democratic discourse while minimizing the harms of misinformation and online abuse.

Freedom of Movement and AI: Preventing Unjust Surveillance and Control

Freedom of movement, the ability to travel and move without unjust restrictions, is a fundamental right enshrined in international human rights law. However, AI-powered surveillance, facial recognition, and predictive policing have introduced significant threats to this freedom.

Governments and private entities increasingly use AI-driven surveillance tools to monitor public spaces, track individuals, and control migration. While these technologies can enhance security, they also raise concerns about mass surveillance, racial profiling, and the restriction of mobility based on algorithmic assessments. In some regions, AI is used to create digital border control systems, using machine learning to determine who can enter a country based on opaque and often discriminatory criteria. Additionally, smart cities and AI-powered transportation systems have been criticized for disproportionately tracking and restricting certain populations, particularly minorities and activists.

To ensure AI does not infringe on freedom of movement, an AI action plan should include:1) Strict regulations on AI-powered surveillance to prevent excessive monitoring and tracking.2) Bans or limitations on real-time facial recognition in public spaces to protect individuals' privacy.3) Transparent use of AI in border control and immigration decisions to prevent discrimination and ensure due process.4) Oversight mechanisms for predictive policing systems to prevent racial profiling and unjust travel restrictions.

By safeguarding freedom of movement, societies can ensure that AI does not become a tool of control and discrimination but rather supports secure and equitable mobility.

Freedom of Assembly and AI: Defending the Right to Protest and Organize

Freedom of assembly—the right to gather, protest, and collectively express opinions—is fundamental to democratic participation. However, AI-driven surveillance, social media monitoring, and predictive analytics have increasingly been used to suppress activism and dissent.

Governments and law enforcement agencies worldwide have deployed AI tools to track protest organizers, monitor online discussions, and predict demonstrations before they occur. AI-powered drones, facial recognition cameras, and social media scraping tools allow authorities to identify individuals attending protests, leading to preemptive arrests or retaliation (36). In some

cases, AI-driven sentiment analysis has been used to label certain groups as "threats" simply based on their political beliefs or affiliations.

To prevent AI from undermining the right to peaceful assembly, an AI action plan must include: 1) Restrictions on AI surveillance during protests to prevent the targeting of demonstrators. 2) Legal protections against AI-driven profiling of activists and political groups. 3) Bans on AI-powered predictive policing targeting protest movements. 4) Transparency in government use of AI for public security to prevent the misuse of technology against peaceful demonstrators.

By ensuring AI does not erode the right to assemble, societies can protect civic engagement and the democratic process, preventing technology from becoming a tool of oppression.

A Human-Centered AI Future: Balancing Innovation and Rights

While AI offers many advantages, its development and deployment must be carefully managed to ensure that fundamental rights are not compromised. The risks associated with AI-driven censorship, surveillance, and social control are real, and without proper safeguards, they can threaten democracy and personal freedoms.

As AI becomes increasingly embedded in society, its impact on fundamental freedoms cannot be ignored. While AI has the potential to improve communication, security, and mobility, it also presents significant risks to freedom of expression, freedom of movement, and freedom of assembly. If left unchecked, AI could become a tool for censorship, mass surveillance, and social control, restricting individuals' ability to speak, travel, and protest without fear.

To prevent this, a comprehensive AI action plan is essential—one that establishes clear ethical guidelines, legal protections, and oversight mechanisms to ensure that AI serves humanity rather than oppresses it. Transparency, accountability, and human oversight must be at the core of AI governance, ensuring that technology aligns with democratic principles and human rights (37).

Ultimately, AI should be a force for empowerment, not restriction. By taking proactive measures to safeguard fundamental freedoms, societies can harness AI's potential while ensuring that technology remains a tool for progress rather than oppression. As AI continues to evolve, governments, businesses, and civil society must work together to create policies that uphold justice, protect human dignity, and preserve the fundamental rights that define free and democratic societies.

To balance technological innovation with human rights, an AI action plan should be built on the principles of transparency, accountability, and human oversight. It should prioritize the protection of free speech, mobility, and assembly while fostering the ethical use of AI. International cooperation and regulatory frameworks must also play a crucial role in establishing global AI governance standards that prevent the misuse of AI by governments and corporations.

Ultimately, AI should be a force for empowerment, not control. By ensuring that AI serves humanity rather than restricting its freedoms, societies can build a future where technology enhances, rather than undermines, the principles of democracy, justice, and human dignity.

Geopolitical Implications and Global Leadership

AI is not just a technology – it's a strategic asset that will influence the global balance of power. The U.S. faces stiff competition from other AI powerhouses, particularly China, and also must coordinate with allies like the EU who are setting their own AI agendas. Navigating this landscape requires a deft geopolitical strategy: winning the technological race while promoting responsible AI use worldwide.

Competition with China is a defining feature of the AI era. China has declared its ambition to be the world leader in AI by 2030 and is investing heavily to get there – from massive government funding for research to national programs nurturing AI talent. In some metrics, China is already ahead (for instance, it leads in the number of AI research publications and has a large domestic AI market). A recent analysis cautioned that China may hold a lead over the U.S. in certain AI activities (38), galvanizing a U.S. response. The U.S. approach to this rivalry has been twofold: out-innovate and out-invest in key AI areas, and restrict China's access to the most critical AI-enabling technologies. On the innovation front, maintaining U.S. leadership means continuing the R&D investments and talent attraction discussed earlier, so the best minds and companies do their work in America. On the defensive front, the U.S. has implemented export controls on advanced semiconductors and AI chips to slow China's progress in cutting-edge AI (given that high-end GPUs are crucial for training AI models). It's a delicate balance – these controls protect national security, but the U.S. must also avoid isolating itself or overly fragmenting the global tech ecosystem.

The U.S. can leverage its strengths against China by emphasizing qualities that make its AI offerings more attractive globally. American AI products and platforms are generally seen as *more trustworthy* than Chinese counterparts by many countries, partly due to concerns over authoritarian misuse of tech by Beijing (39). The U.S. should capitalize on this trust advantage: for example, by providing AI solutions (in healthcare, education, agriculture, etc.) to developing regions, the U.S. and its companies can undercut China's influence and ensure international AI infrastructure isn't dominated by one regime's standards. Microsoft's partnership to build AI centers in Africa and an international fund for AI infrastructure is one private-sector example of extending U.S. AI leadership outward (40). U.S. foreign assistance and development finance

could similarly support adoption of American-led AI in partner countries, emphasizing transparency, privacy, and security. As one tech leader put it, the U.S. is “in a strong position to win the essential race with China by advancing international adoption of American AI” and leveraging its unmatched private sector investments (41). While competing, the U.S. also needs to manage risks of an AI arms race. Unchecked rivalry could spur rapid deployment of unsafe AI or even military AI escalation. Thus, dialogue with China is important to set some *guardrails* – much like nuclear arms control during the Cold War. The U.S. and China (along with other powers) might find mutual interest in agreements on AI safety in military systems or norms against using AI for destabilizing cyberattacks, etc. Keeping channels open (through academic collaborations or joint workshops on AI safety) could help reduce misperceptions. However, given the broader strategic tensions, the U.S. will likely rely more on its network of allies to promote its vision of AI governance.

In contrast to the competitive stance with China, the European Union is a partner in values, though it presents a different challenge: the EU is asserting leadership in AI regulation. The EU’s upcoming AI Act is slated to be the world’s first comprehensive AI law, and it reflects a more precautionary approach. This could impact U.S. companies operating in Europe and potentially set de facto global standards (the way Europe’s GDPR did for privacy). The U.S. must diplomatically engage with the EU to find common ground so that innovation isn’t stifled, and transatlantic digital trade remains open. Through forums like the U.S.-EU Trade Council, American and European officials are already trying to align AI governance approaches. They won’t agree on everything – the EU favors stricter rules, whereas the U.S. often prefers innovation-friendly guidelines (42). – but a degree of coordination is crucial. For example, the two sides have discussed a *voluntary AI Code of Conduct* for industry as an interim step until regulation comes. The goal should be to minimize conflicting requirements and emphasize shared principles (like transparency, accountability, and the protection of fundamental rights). By partnering with the EU and other democracies on AI standards, the U.S. strengthens a coalition of responsible AI developers that can present an alternative to authoritarian tech governance.

Lastly, promoting responsible AI globally means leading by example. The U.S. should demonstrate that AI can be developed in line with democratic values and used to benefit society. This involves continuing to champion initiatives like using AI for good (e.g. AI for climate resilience, disaster response, improving healthcare in poorer countries). When the U.S. deploys AI tools abroad or assists other nations, it should adhere to high standards of ethics and respect for local laws, setting a positive precedent. Additionally, U.S. leadership in global bodies (like urging the UN to take on AI issues or creating an international panel for AI akin to the IPCC for climate) can help ensure a rules-based order for AI. The State Department has explicitly tied AI advancement to democratic principles, arguing that the U.S. and allies can further scientific progress *and* “promote democracy and human rights” by shaping AI norms (43). In conclusion, the United States can navigate the geopolitics of AI by staying true to its core values while pushing the frontiers of innovation. By fostering innovation at home and with allies, establishing

sensible oversight, and engaging abroad with both competitors and friends, the U.S. can remain the global leader in AI. Striking this balance is critical – poorly crafted policies or a failure to cooperate internationally could undermine U.S. advantages. But with a forward-looking strategy, the U.S. can “*remain at the forefront of the global AI race while ensuring accountability and ethical development.*”(44). In doing so, America will not only out-compete rivals, but also steer the evolution of AI in a direction that is safe, equitable, and beneficial for the world.

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